



AI Highlight ▾

Physical trauma reactions can persist after the danger has passed, even when you know you're safe. With complex or developmental trauma, direct work on the deepest memory can be overwhelming, so a gradual approach may be enough: Buddhist nun Pema Chodron calls it a “feather touch,” and Peter Levine, the founder of Somatic Experiencing, calls gentle work around the edges “pendulation.” The same principle extends to inner-child therapy: you can know what the younger part needs yet enter the child-state so fully that too little adult perspective remains to provide it.

